

Nikki Kode

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Education

Carnegie Mellon University

Masters of Human-Computer Interaction

GPA: 3.86/4.00

Pittsburgh, PA

Aug 2026

Bachelor of Computer Science and Arts (concentration in Music Technology)

May 2025

GPA: 3.63/4.00, University Honors

Skills

Programming & Frameworks: Python, C, C#, HTML, JavaScript, CSS, LaTeX, SML, Django, React, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Vite, Rust (Tauri), PostgreSQL, Redis, SQLite

DevOps & Infrastructure: Docker, Docker Compose, AWS EC2, Nginx, GitHub Actions CI/CD

Real-time & AI Integration: WebSockets, Daphne (ASGI), Gemini API, OpenAI API

Software: Figma, Unity, Godot, Logic Pro X, Ableton Live, Adobe Suite, Camtasia Video Editor

Languages: Intermediate Spanish

Project Experience

D&D Beyond Desktop | Personal Project

Oct 2025–Present

- Built a desktop app using React, TypeScript, and Tailwind CSS on a Rust/Tauri backend, implementing full client-side routing via React Router and persistent local storage of character data as JSON files
- Developed a comprehensive character management system including a multi-tab creation wizard, level-up mechanics, spell slot tracking, dice roller w/ roll history, & a compendium browser pulling data from the D&D 5e API
- Implemented dark/light theming, custom accent colors, and a markdown-based campaign notes editor with autosave, character linking, and live preview

Trello Clone | Full-Stack Web Application

Oct–Dec 2025

- Built a full-stack task management app with React/TypeScript frontend and Django REST Framework backend, implementing JWT authentication, role-based permissions, and multi-tenant access control across a 3-person team
- Engineered real-time collaboration features using Django Channels and WebSockets with Redis as the channel layer, enabling live task updates and concurrent editing with optimistic locking
- Integrated AI-powered subtask generation via Gemini and OpenAI APIs, and implemented a full CI/CD pipeline with GitHub Actions, deploying to AWS EC2 via Docker Compose with Nginx as a reverse proxy
- Achieved 98% backend unit test coverage and 91.4% integration test coverage across 215 total tests

Web Application Final Project | Basilisk Bask

Mar–May 2025

- Led all backend development for a 4-person team, engineering a real-time multiplayer card battle game for up to 4 players using Django Channels and WebSockets, implementing 5 concurrent WebSocket consumers handling combat, lobby management, ability selection, dragon selection, and end-game scoring
- Designed and implemented all core game logic including a deck-building system, damage-over-time effect engine, simultaneous attack resolution, and per-round state management across multiple Django models
- Architected & managed full server-side infrastructure, deploying app on AWS EC2 w/ Daphne as the ASGI server

Work Experience

PM & Researcher | Master's Capstone | XR Interaction Design Paradigms for ARM Holdings

Jan–Aug 2026

- Leading IRB-approved mixed-methods research with 70+ participants across two expert populations (tattoo artists and UX designers) using semi-structured interviews and participatory design techniques (e.g., body-mapping on a mannequin arm) to surface principles for on-skin XR interface design
- Designing and executing evaluative studies with a VR prototype to validate design principles with a general population, informing a research paper intended for publication
- Managing a 5-person cross-functional team in direct collaboration with ARM Holdings, coordinating research timelines, IRB protocols, and deliverables across the full study arc

Grader | Designing Human-Centered Software

Pittsburgh, PA

Carnegie Mellon University

Aug 2024– May 2025

- Assessed student coursework including class participation, homework, and group projects
- Provided constructive feedback to students to support understanding of course concepts

Graphics Intern | MarketVision

Cincinnati, OH | May–Aug 2022

- Supported digital asset migration and platform transition, recreating visual assets in Adobe Illustrator and producing onboarding documentation for internal teams